

Stage 3G Physics Note: Off-Diagonal Conformal Cartoon Translation

GL-with-AI Project

June 15, 2026

1 Scope

Stage 3G extends the Stage 3F diagonal conformal-cartoon translation to a reduced metric block with nonzero h_{xz} or γ_{xz} . It is a derivation and symbolic-validation note only. No C++ source terms or variables are implemented, and symbolic execution alone does not establish physical correctness of an evolution.

2 Metric Ansatz

The reduced physical spatial metric is

$$dl^2 = \gamma_{xx} dx^2 + 2\gamma_{xz} dx dz + \gamma_{zz} dz^2 + x^2 \gamma_{ww} d\Omega_2^2. \quad (1)$$

The gridded directions are x, z . The hidden transverse directions are two equivalent w directions, so

$$N_{\text{hidden}} = \text{GR_SPACEDIM} - \text{CH_SPACEDIM} = 4 - 2 = 2. \quad (2)$$

As before, h_{ww} and γ_{ww} are hidden Cartesian-like components; the spherical/cartoon reconstruction supplies the external factor x^2 .

3 Determinants

The reduced physical block determinant is

$$D_\gamma = \gamma_{xx}\gamma_{zz} - \gamma_{xz}^2. \quad (3)$$

Thus the cartoon/Cartesian-like four-dimensional physical determinant is

$$\det \gamma_{4D} = D_\gamma \gamma_{ww}^2. \quad (4)$$

With

$$h_{ij} = \chi \gamma_{ij}, \quad \gamma_{ij} = \chi^{-1} h_{ij}, \quad (5)$$

the conformal factor is

$$\chi = [(\gamma_{xx}\gamma_{zz} - \gamma_{xz}^2) \gamma_{ww}^2]^{-1/4}. \quad (6)$$

For the conformal block,

$$D_h = h_{xx}h_{zz} - h_{xz}^2, \quad (7)$$

and the conformal determinant condition is

$$\det h_{4D} = D_h h_{ww}^2 = (h_{xx} h_{zz} - h_{xz}^2) h_{ww}^2 = 1. \quad (8)$$

This determinant is imposed on the reduced cartoon/Cartesian-like variables; it does not include spherical-coordinate Jacobian factors.

4 Inverse Metric

The inverse conformal block is

$$h^{xx} = \frac{h_{zz}}{D_h}, \quad h^{xz} = -\frac{h_{xz}}{D_h}, \quad h^{zz} = \frac{h_{xx}}{D_h}, \quad h^{ww} = \frac{1}{h_{ww}}. \quad (9)$$

5 Tracelessness

The conformal tracelessness condition is the full four-dimensional one,

$$h^{xx} A_{xx} + 2h^{xz} A_{xz} + h^{zz} A_{zz} + 2h^{ww} A_{ww} = 0. \quad (10)$$

The $2h^{xz} A_{xz}$ term is the symmetric off-diagonal contraction. The $2h^{ww} A_{ww}$ term is the hidden-direction multiplicity. Solving for the hidden component gives

$$A_{ww} = -\frac{h_{ww}}{2} (h^{xx} A_{xx} + 2h^{xz} A_{xz} + h^{zz} A_{zz}). \quad (11)$$

6 Extrinsic Curvature

For `GR_SPACEDIM = 4`,

$$K_{ij} = \chi^{-1} \left(A_{ij} + \frac{h_{ij} K}{4} \right). \quad (12)$$

The off-diagonal component is therefore

$$K_{xz} = \chi^{-1} \left(A_{xz} + \frac{h_{xz} K}{4} \right). \quad (13)$$

The trace is

$$K = \gamma^{xx} K_{xx} + 2\gamma^{xz} K_{xz} + \gamma^{zz} K_{zz} + 2\gamma^{ww} K_{ww}. \quad (14)$$

The denominator 4 is the full physical spatial dimension, not the two gridded directions and not ordinary $3 + 1$ intuition.

7 Script Checks

The repository script `docs/derivations/offdiagonal_conformal_cartoon_sympy.py` checks the physical and conformal determinant identities, the inverse metric, the explicit normalized $\det h_{4D} = 1$ guard, full four-dimensional tracelessness, reconstruction of $K_{xx}, K_{xz}, K_{zz}, K_{ww}$, and a denominator guard showing that $p = 4$ works while $p = 2$ and $p = 3$ fail under a numeric substitution.

It also checks the diagonal limit

$$h_{xz} = \gamma_{xz} = A_{xz} = K_{xz} = 0, \quad (15)$$

which recovers the Stage 3F diagonal formulas.

8 Companion Ricci Gate

The companion repository script `docs/derivations/offdiagonal_ricci_flat_gate_sympy.py` checks the geometric Ricci engine on flat metrics with genuine off-diagonal cross terms. The constant-shear case is

$$dl^2 = (1 + \lambda^2) dx^2 + 2\lambda dx dz + dz^2 + x^2 d\Omega_2^2, \quad (16)$$

corresponding to $dZ = dz + \lambda dx$. The x -dependent shear case is

$$dl^2 = (1 + x^2) dx^2 + 2x dx dz + dz^2 + x^2 d\Omega_2^2, \quad (17)$$

corresponding to $dZ = dz + x dx$. The script verifies that the full matrix inverse is used and that all Ricci tensor components and the Ricci scalar vanish for both metrics. This is a targeted off-diagonal Ricci regression, not a full CCZ4 RHS validation.

9 Limitations

This note is an algebraic translation and validation scaffold. It does not derive the full CCZ4 right-hand sides, does not address regularity near $x = 0$, and does not add or validate any C++ implementation.